TEACHER GUIDE DRAFT

Leaving Certificate Business (current syllabus)

Leading: direction and delegation



Unit 3: Managing 1
3.2 Leading: direction, delegation

A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise leading: direction and delegation on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min	45 min	60 min	75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same.

1 Manage or lead?

Round 1

Your manager plans the staff rota, sets the budgets and checks the results each week.

Is this mainly management or leadership?

- **A** Leadership: setting a vision
- **B** Leadership: inspiring staff
- **C** Neither: it is just admin
- **D** Management: planning and control

ANSWER

✓ Management: planning and control

Why: Planning, organising and controlling are management; leaders set direction.

2 Autocratic effects

Round 1

A manager decides everything alone and gives orders.

Which two effects are most likely over time?

- **A** Decisions take longer
- **B** Fast decisions in a crisis
- **C** Staff feel more involved
- **D** Staff gain more responsibility
- **E** Skilled staff feel undervalued

ANSWER

✓ Fast decisions in a crisis
✓ Skilled staff feel undervalued

Why: Deciding alone is quick, but skilled staff want a say.

3 Styles by staff say

Round 2

Three leadership styles.

Order them by how much staff decide, least first?

- **A** Laissez-faire
- **B** Autocratic
- **C** Democratic

ANSWER

1. Autocratic
2. Democratic
3. Laissez-faire

Why: Autocratic: the leader decides; democratic: staff share; laissez-faire: staff decide.

Topic tasks

4 Error rate rise

Round 2

A new laissez-faire manager took over.

Rise in the error rate, as a %?

Deals a month	**200 deals**
Pricing errors before	**16 errors**
Pricing errors now	**24 errors**

ANSWER

50%

(24 − 16) ÷ 16 × 100 = 50%

Why: Little direction suits skilled staff; here errors rose by 50%.

5 New team, deadline

Round 3

A new, untrained team must deliver a big fleet order by Friday.

Which approach fits, and why?

A Clear instructions from the manager

B Let the team decide how

ANSWER

✓ Clear instructions from the manager

Why: Untrained staff and little time need clear direction.

6 Laissez-faire risk

Round 3

A laissez-faire manager runs a team of new trainees. Errors and complaints rise.

What best explains the problem?

A The manager is too controlling

B Staff have too little freedom

C Decisions are too centralised

D Trainees lack the skill to work alone

ANSWER

✓ Trainees lack the skill to work alone

Why: Laissez-faire suits skilled, motivated staff; trainees need direction.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions. Pick the question topic “Leading: direction and delegation”: the 6 come from these 10 questions.

1 A manager makes every decision alone and gives orders. Which leadership style is this?
✔ **Autocratic**

2 The owner asks the sales team to help choose the new opening hours. Which leadership style is this?
✔ **Democratic**

3 What is delegation?
✔ **Giving a subordinate authority to carry out a task**

4 Which is a benefit of delegation for a dealership manager?
✔ **Frees the manager’s time for bigger decisions**

5 A laissez-faire manager...
✔ **lets experienced staff decide how to work**

6 A fire breaks out in the workshop. Which leadership style suits the next ten minutes?
✔ **Autocratic: clear orders, fast**

7 A manager delegates a task but then checks and redoes every step. What is the problem?
✔ **Authority was not really given, so staff gain nothing**

8 Which is a disadvantage of autocratic leadership?
✔ **Staff ideas are lost and morale can fall**

9 Giving direction as a leader means...
✔ **setting clear goals and showing the way**

10 New, inexperienced staff must follow tight safety rules. Which style fits best at first?
✔ **Autocratic, until they learn the rules**